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OCTOBER COALITION PROTEST

2,500 RALLY FOR BLACK EDUCATION DEMANDS AT U.C. BERKELEY



(Berkeley, Calif.) - More than 2,500 students, faculty and concerned individuals rallied at two separate locations at the University of California at Berkeley here last Friday, October 17, demonstrating strong support for establishing positive affirmative action programs both on campus and in the community.

First, at noon, a crowd of over 2,000 jammed their way into historic Sproul Plaza where activist sociology professor Harry Edwards, mainstay of the October Coalition which sponsored the event, kicked off a weekend-filled calendar of events with an eloquent speech on the need for a united campus-community push for full Black access to and involvement in higher education. (See centerfold.)

Next, at Edwards Stadium, over 500 persons heard David G. Du Bois, official spokesperson of the Black Panther Party and Editor-in-Chief of THE BLACK PANTHER, Michael Dunn, president of the East Oakland Clergy, and several other campus and community leaders address the issues of affirmative action in higher education. (See centerfold for excerpts of Brother Du Bois' speech.)

Although scheduled speakers such as Dick Gregory, Jessie Jackson and Angela Davis were unable to attend, the Friday rally was successful in presenting the issue of affirmative action to the predominantly campus crowd

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Over 2,500 people rallied for affirmative action in education at the University of California, Berkeley, at an event sponsored by the October Coalition. The October Coalition is headed by popular sociology professor HARRY EDWARDS.